RELIANCE CARE SERVICES LLC

Staff Orientation Manual — Provider Developed Orientation

New Jersey Home and Community Based Services (HCBS) Provider

Effective January 1, 2025 • Aligned with NJ Division of Developmental Disabilities (NJDDD) Training Requirements · NJ DSP Core Competency Career Pathway · N.J.A.C. 10:44 Compliant

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SECTION 1

Welcome & Introduction

1.1 Welcome Letter from Agency Leadership

Dear New Member of the Reliance Care Services LLC Team,

On behalf of the entire leadership team and the individuals we are privileged to serve, welcome to Reliance Care Services LLC. We are genuinely delighted that you have joined our organization, and we look forward to building a partnership with you grounded in compassion, professionalism, and a shared commitment to excellence in care.

At Reliance Care Services LLC, we believe that the work you are about to undertake is among the most meaningful and impactful work a person can do. As a Direct Support Professional (DSP) or agency staff member, you will play a central role in the lives of individuals with intellectual and developmental disabilities — individuals who deserve nothing less than the highest quality of support, delivered with dignity, respect, and genuine regard for their unique personhood.

Our agency is built on a simple but powerful belief: every individual we support is a full and equal member of their community. They have dreams, goals, preferences, and rights. Your role is not to manage or control — it is to walk alongside, to empower, and to support. The difference between those two approaches is everything.

This orientation manual has been developed to introduce you to who we are, what we do, and how we do it. It outlines the values, policies, and professional standards that define Reliance Care Services LLC. We ask that you read every section carefully, ask questions freely, and approach this information with the seriousness and open-mindedness it deserves. This is not paperwork — it is the foundation of your professional practice here.

Thank you for choosing Reliance Care Services LLC. Thank you for choosing to make a difference. We are honored to have you on this team.

Warm regards, Agency Leadership & Administration — Reliance Care Services LLC, New Jersey HCBS Provider.

1.2 About This Manual

This Staff Orientation Manual is a formally developed orientation document prepared by Reliance Care Services LLC in fulfillment of the NJ Division of Developmental Disabilities (NJDDD) Provider Developed Orientation requirement. All new employees and contractors who provide direct support services to individuals enrolled in NJDDD programs are required to review this manual in its entirety prior to or concurrent with their first days of employment.

> *Completion of this orientation manual, together with the signed Acknowledgment Form (Section 10), constitutes fulfillment of the NJDDD Provider Developed Orientation requirement. This document must be reviewed before a new DSP assumes sole responsibility for supporting any individual.*

This manual covers agency background, mission and values, service descriptions, professional standards, personnel policies, regulatory compliance, and emergency procedures. It is a living document, reviewed and updated at least annually or as required by changes in NJDDD regulations, state law, or agency policy.

SECTION 2

Agency Overview

2.1 About Reliance Care Services LLC

Reliance Care Services LLC is a New Jersey-licensed Home and Community Based Services (HCBS) provider dedicated to serving individuals with intellectual and developmental disabilities (IDD). The agency is enrolled as an approved provider under the New Jersey Division of Developmental Disabilities (NJDDD) and operates within the following programs:

- Supports Program — Providing individualized, community-based supports to eligible adults with IDD
- Community Care Program — Offering a broad range of residential and day services in community settings

Reliance Care Services LLC is headquartered in New Jersey and serves individuals across New Jersey communities. Every service we provide is delivered in community-integrated settings in keeping with the federal HCBS Final Rule and NJ state standards.

> *DSP Tip — Your role as a DSP places you at the heart of our agency's mission. Every interaction you have with an individual matters — your consistency, your professionalism, and your genuine care make all the difference in the life of the person you support.*

2.2 Organizational Structure

Role / Position	Primary Responsibilities
Executive Director / Administrator	Overall leadership, regulatory compliance, strategic direction, agency-wide policy oversight, NJDDD relationship management
Program Supervisors / Coordinators	Day-to-day operational oversight, DSP supervision and coaching, ISP implementation monitoring, incident management, scheduling

Role / Position	Primary Responsibilities
Direct Support Professionals (DSPs)	Direct service delivery, ISP implementation, documentation, community support, health & safety monitoring, mandatory reporting
Administrative / Support Staff	Billing, human resources, records management, scheduling support, compliance documentation

2.3 Licensing & Accreditation

Reliance Care Services LLC operates in full compliance with all applicable state and federal regulatory requirements governing HCBS providers in New Jersey:

- NJ Division of Developmental Disabilities (NJDDD) — Provider approval and ongoing compliance monitoring
- NJ Administrative Code N.J.A.C. 10:44 — Standards for community care programs serving individuals with developmental disabilities
- Federal HCBS Final Rule (42 CFR Part 441) — Federal standards for settings, individual rights, and service delivery
- New Jersey Medicaid Program — Medicaid waiver requirements governing service authorization, billing, and provider standards
- NJ Division of Consumer Affairs / Workforce Development — Employment law compliance and background check requirements

SECTION 3

Mission, Vision & Philosophy

3.1 Mission Statement

> *Reliance Care Services LLC is dedicated to empowering individuals with intellectual and developmental disabilities to live fulfilling, self-determined lives through compassionate, person-centered support, community inclusion, and unwavering commitment to dignity and respect.*

3.2 Vision Statement

> *A community where every individual with a disability has the opportunity, support, and freedom to thrive on their own terms.*

3.3 Core Values

◆ **Person-Centered Care**

We honor each individual's unique goals, preferences, and choices. Support is always tailored to the person — never a one-size-fits-all approach. The individual's voice is the most important voice in the room.

◆ **Dignity & Respect**

Every person we support deserves to be treated with genuine kindness, respect, and consideration — regardless of their support needs, behavior, or circumstances. Dignity is non-negotiable.

◆ **Empowerment**

We support individuals to advocate for themselves, make informed decisions, and take meaningful control over their own lives. Our role is to expand possibilities, not to limit them.

◆ **Integrity**

We act with honesty, transparency, and accountability in everything we do. We hold ourselves to the highest ethical standards, especially when no one is

watching.

◆ **Community Inclusion**

We actively support each individual's participation in meaningful community life — building relationships, accessing community resources, and being a valued part of their neighborhood and city.

◆ **Excellence**

We strive for the highest standards in care and professional practice. We are committed to continuous learning, skill development, and quality improvement.

◆ **Cultural Competence**

We value and respect the diverse cultural, linguistic, religious, and personal backgrounds of every individual we serve and every colleague we work with.

3.4 Agency Philosophy

Reliance Care Services LLC operates under a clear and principled philosophy: individuals with intellectual and developmental disabilities are equal, full members of their communities, with the same rights, opportunities, and inherent dignity as any other person. This philosophy is foundational. It shapes every service we deliver, every policy we write, and every interaction our staff have with individuals.

We firmly reject a deficit-based model of disability. Instead, we embrace a strength-based, person-first, and trauma-informed approach to service delivery. This means we:

- See the whole person — their strengths, gifts, experiences, and potential
- Start with what the individual wants and works toward — not with what a system dictates
- Recognize that behaviors, preferences, and needs have meaning and context
- Honor the impact of past experiences, including trauma, on an individual's current life
- Treat every interaction as an opportunity to build trust, safety, and connection

Support at Reliance Care Services LLC is individualized, flexible, and driven by each person's Individualized Support Plan (ISP). Staff are partners in the individual's journey — not caretakers controlling outcomes.

SECTION 4

Agency Goals

Goal 1: Deliver Safe, High-Quality, Person-Centered HCBS

Quality is not defined solely by regulatory compliance — it is measured by whether each person we serve is living a richer, more self-determined life because of the support we provide.

Goal 2: Promote Community Integration and Meaningful Participation

Our agency actively supports every individual in accessing their community — not as an observer, but as a participant and member. We reject segregation and isolation in any form.

Goal 3: Hire, Train, and Retain Highly Qualified and Compassionate DSPs

We invest in robust training, ongoing professional development, and a supportive work environment because the quality of care we provide is directly tied to the quality of our staff.

Goal 4: Ensure Full Compliance with All Applicable Regulations

Reliance Care Services LLC maintains full compliance with all NJDDD requirements, Medicaid waiver standards, federal HCBS Final Rule obligations, and NJ Administrative Code provisions.

Goal 5: Foster a Workplace Culture of Respect, Accountability, and Continuous Improvement

We hold ourselves to high standards of accountability — leadership included. We foster open communication, professional growth, and mutual respect at all levels.

Goal 6: Support the Well-Being of Every Individual Served

We approach well-being holistically — recognizing that health is not just the absence of illness, but the presence of connection, safety, purpose, and joy.

Goal 7: Build Strong Partnerships with Families and Community Stakeholders

We communicate proactively, respond to concerns promptly, and actively engage partners in ISP planning and implementation.

SECTION 5

Services Provided

Reliance Care Services LLC is approved to provide the following NJDDD-funded HCBS. All services are delivered in accordance with the individual's ISP, NJDDD service definitions, and applicable Medicaid waiver requirements.

5.1 Community Based Supports (CBS)

Component	Details
Description	Individualized assistance in community settings, focused on daily living skills, community participation, and personal independence.
Setting	Community settings — NOT in the individual's home or a licensed congregate facility.
Service Focus	Skill building, independence promotion, community navigation, social skill development, safety awareness
DSP Role	Assist with transportation, community navigation, social interactions, skill-building, and safety monitoring. Document all services and the individual's responses accurately.

> *DSP Tip — When providing CBS, always be mindful of promoting the individual's independence. Provide the least intrusive level of support necessary.*

5.2 Community Inclusion (CI)

Component	Details
Description	Supports the individual's participation in community activities, social environments, events, and relationships alongside non-disabled peers in fully integrated settings.
Goal	Reduce social isolation; promote meaningful relationships, community membership, and a sense of belonging.

Component	Details
HCBS Alignment	Must be delivered in integrated community settings consistent with the federal HCBS Final Rule.
DSP Role	Facilitate access to community activities of the individual's choosing; provide the least intrusive support possible; document participation and engagement.

5.3 Individual Supports (IS)

Component	Details
Description	In-home and community-based assistance tailored to the individual's needs in activities of daily living (ADLs), personal care, household management, and skill development.
Setting	The individual's own home and/or the community, as authorized in the ISP.
Service Focus	Personal hygiene and grooming, meal preparation, household tasks, medication management (within authorized scope), budgeting, safety, skill development
DSP Role	Follow the ISP precisely; provide behavioral support as outlined in the BSP; document all services and report changes immediately.

> *Important — DSPs must never provide support beyond what is authorized in the ISP. If you believe additional support is needed, contact your supervisor to initiate an ISP amendment.*

5.4 Respite Services

Component	Details
Description	Temporary, substitute support to individuals when their primary unpaid caregiver requires relief.
Setting	May be provided in the individual's home or in a community setting, as authorized.
Duration	Varies based on ISP authorization — from a few hours to multiple days.

Component	Details
DSP Role	Provide safe, engaging, high-quality care during the caregiver's absence; follow all ISP/BSP directives; document services and contact supervisor with any concerns.

5.5 Transportation

Component	Details
Description	Non-emergency transportation to community resources, medical appointments, employment, educational programs, recreational activities, and authorized services.
Requirements	Valid NJ driver's license; adequately insured vehicle; compliance with all agency transportation protocols and NJ motor vehicle laws.
DSP Role	Ensure safe transport; assist with boarding/exiting; adhere to traffic laws; document trips; never transport to unauthorized locations.
Prohibited	Cell phone use while driving; unauthorized passengers; route deviation without supervisory approval.

> *Safety Requirement — All DSPs providing transportation must ensure individuals are properly secured with seat belts or appropriate adaptive equipment at all times. Any vehicle accident must be reported immediately.*

SECTION 6

Practices & Service Delivery Standards

6.1 Person-Centered Practices

Person-centered support places the individual at the absolute center of all planning, decision-making, and service delivery. Support is organized around what matters most to the person — their goals, preferences, relationships, and vision for their own life.

The Individualized Support Plan (ISP)

The ISP is the cornerstone document of every individual's support. Developed collaboratively with the individual, family/guardian, Support Coordinator, and the provider, it outlines:

- The individual's personal goals and desired outcomes
- Specific supports and services, frequency, and duration
- Staffing requirements and individual-specific protocols
- Health and safety information
- Behavioral support strategies
- Preferences, communication styles, and cultural considerations

> *DSP Legal Obligation — The ISP is a legally binding service agreement. DSPs must read, understand, and implement the ISP before beginning services. Failure to follow the ISP may constitute a regulatory violation.*

DSP Role in ISP Implementation

- Read and thoroughly understand the ISP before providing services
- Implement support strategies exactly as described in the ISP
- Observe and document progress toward ISP goals
- Report concerns about ISP appropriateness to your supervisor
- Never substitute your own judgment for the individual's stated preferences
- Actively support the individual in making informed choices daily

6.2 Documentation Requirements

Every service session must be documented. Service notes must include date, exact start/end times, service code, location, activities and supports provided, individual's response, progress toward ISP goals, any incidents, and DSP authentication.

> *Documentation Standard — Documentation must be objective, factual, and professional. Never use subjective, judgmental, or demeaning language. If it wasn't documented, it didn't happen.*

Electronic Visit Verification (EVV)

- Clock in via the agency-approved EVV system at the start of every shift
- Clock out via the EVV system at the end of every shift
- Ensure clock-in/out accurately reflect actual service times
- Never clock in or out on behalf of another DSP — this constitutes fraud
- Never falsify location data or service times

> *EVV Non-Compliance Consequences — Failure to comply may result in claim denials, Medicaid billing violations, and potential fraud investigation.*

Incident Reporting

Reportable incidents include falls/injuries, medication errors, allegations of abuse/neglect/exploitation, behavioral incidents with injury, elopement, hospitalizations, law enforcement involvement, and any event posing risk to the individual's health or safety. Report verbally to supervisor immediately and document in writing within required timeframes.

6.3 HIPAA & Confidentiality

HIPAA protects the privacy and security of individuals' health information. PHI includes names, addresses, DOB, SSN, diagnoses, medications, treatment plans, service records, ISP content, progress notes, and photographs/recordings.

DSP Obligations Under HIPAA

- Never discuss personal information in public places where others may overhear
- Never share information with anyone — including family members — without proper written authorization
- Protect all paper and electronic records from unauthorized access
- Never post information, images, or identifying details on social media
- Report any suspected breach of PHI to your supervisor immediately
- Access only the records necessary to perform your job duties

> *HIPAA Violation Consequences — Federal civil penalties from $100 to $50,000 per violation, criminal charges in egregious cases, and immediate termination.*

6.4 Positive Behavior Support (PBS)

PBS is a research-based, proactive, strength-based approach grounded in the understanding that all behavior is communication. PBS focuses on understanding behavior function, modifying environments, teaching alternative skills, responding consistently, and building positive relationships.

Behavior Support Plan (BSP)

Individuals with significant behavioral needs have a BSP that outlines target behaviors, antecedents, function, proactive and reactive strategies, crisis procedures, and data collection. DSPs must implement the BSP with fidelity — never improvise behavior support.

> *Prohibition on Aversive Interventions — Strictly prohibited: physical restraint (except immediate emergency per protocol), seclusion, threats, humiliation, withholding of food, or any pain-inducing intervention. Violations result in immediate termination and mandatory NJDDD reporting.*

6.5 Health & Safety

Medication administration may only be performed by DSPs who have successfully completed NJDDD-compliant Medication Administration training and received

specific authorization. Practice universal precautions at all times. Hold current, valid First Aid and CPR/AED certifications. Monitor environments for safety hazards and report concerns promptly.

6.6 Rights of Individuals Supported

Right	Description
Self-Determination	Make choices about their own life — where they live, what they do, whom they spend time with, and how they receive support.
Informed Consent	Receive clear, understandable information and agree or refuse without coercion.
Privacy & Confidentiality	Privacy in personal matters, communications, and health information.
Due Process	Contest decisions about services, placements, or rights through a formal grievance and appeal process.
Freedom from Abuse, Neglect & Exploitation	Absolute right to be free from physical, emotional, sexual, or financial abuse, neglect, and exploitation.
Community Integration	Participate in community life alongside people without disabilities, per HCBS Final Rule and ADA.

Mandatory Reporter Obligations

All staff are mandatory reporters under NJ law. If you witness, suspect, or receive a disclosure of abuse, neglect, or exploitation — you are legally required to report it to NJDDD IMS, NJ APS, NJ DCP&P (when under 18), and internally to the agency immediately.

> *Failure to Report Is a Crime — Failure to report suspected abuse or neglect of a vulnerable adult or child by a mandatory reporter is a criminal offense in NJ. If you are unsure whether to report, report.*

6.7 HCBS Final Rule Compliance

The Federal HCBS Final Rule (42 CFR Part 441) establishes standards ensuring HCBS settings genuinely support community integration. Individual rights include accessing the community at will, controlling their own schedules, privacy in personal space, having visitors of their choosing, choosing roommates, and receiving services in integrated settings.

DSP Role in HCBS Compliance

- Never restrict access to the community or personal space without written ISP-authorized justification
- Never impose rules or schedules for staff convenience rather than the individual's benefit
- Actively support the individual's right to make choices — including choices you may personally disagree with
- Never facilitate or permit institutional practices
- Report any setting or practice violating HCBS standards to your supervisor immediately

SECTION 7

Personnel Policies

7.1 Equal Employment Opportunity (EEO)

Reliance Care Services LLC is an Equal Opportunity Employer. The agency does not discriminate on the basis of race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy and gender identity), national origin, age, disability, genetic information, sexual orientation, marital status, or any other protected characteristic. Retaliation against anyone who reports discrimination in good faith is strictly prohibited.

ADA Accommodations — Reasonable accommodations will be provided to qualified employees with disabilities, unless doing so would pose an undue hardship. Contact Administration to initiate the interactive accommodation process.

7.2 Code of Conduct & Professional Ethics

Professional Appearance

- Dress appropriately for a professional, community-integrated work setting
- Clothing must be clean, neat, and suitable for shift activities
- Avoid clothing with offensive imagery, language, or graphics
- Follow any additional dress code standards specified by the agency or individual ISP

Cell Phone Use

Personal cell phone use is prohibited during active service time with individuals, except in emergencies. DSPs must give their full attention to the individual they are supporting.

Social Media Policy

- Photographing, recording, or filming individuals is strictly prohibited without explicit written authorization
- Never post photos, videos, names, or identifying information about individuals on any social media platform
- Do not post work-related information, complaints, or agency-specific details on personal social media

- Violations constitute a HIPAA violation and will result in immediate disciplinary action

Dual Relationships, Gifts & Loans

- Personal, romantic, or financial relationships between staff and individuals supported are strictly prohibited
- Do not exchange personal contact information without supervisory approval
- Accepting gifts, loans, money, or items of value from individuals or families is prohibited
- Do not lend money to individuals, family members, or co-workers

Confidentiality obligations extend beyond the period of employment.

7.3 Attendance & Scheduling

- Notify supervisor or on-call contact no later than two (2) hours prior to shift start if you cannot report
- Text messages alone do not constitute proper notification — a verbal confirmation is required
- Chronic absenteeism will result in progressive disciplinary action
- No-call/no-show may result in immediate disciplinary action up to termination; two consecutive incidents may be treated as voluntary resignation

7.4 Incident Reporting & Mandatory Reporting

1. Ensure the immediate safety of the individual (call 911 if required)
2. Notify your direct Program Supervisor by phone immediately
3. If supervisor is unreachable, contact the designated on-call supervisor or administrator
4. Complete a written incident report within the required timeframe
5. Submit the written report through the agency's designated incident reporting system
6. Cooperate fully with any investigation

> *NJDDD Reporting Timelines — Certain NJDDD Reportable Events require immediate verbal notification and written reporting*

> *within 24 hours. Escalate immediately so the agency can meet its reporting obligations.*

7.5 Background Checks & Clearances

- NJDDD Background Check Unit (BCU) Clearance — Required for all direct care staff per N.J.A.C. 10:44
- Criminal History Record Background Check (CHRC) — State and federal fingerprint review
- NJ Sex Offender Registry Check — All staff with direct individual contact
- Motor Vehicle Record (MVR) Check — Required for transportation services
- NJ Child Abuse Registry (CAR) Check — As applicable

Staff have an ongoing obligation to disclose any arrest, charge, or conviction to administration within 24 hours. Failure to disclose may result in immediate termination.

7.6 Training Requirements

Before Assuming Sole Responsibility

- Provider Developed Orientation (this manual) — Review and acknowledgment
- CPR and First Aid Certification
- Fire Evacuation and Emergency Procedures
- Medication Administration Training (if applicable)
- Individual-Specific Specialized Training (per ISP, prior to first solo shift)
- EVV System Training

Within 90 Days of Hire

- HIPAA and Confidentiality
- Mandated Reporter Training (NJ-approved)
- Understanding and Supporting People with IDD
- Person-Centered Practices and Planning
- Positive Behavior Support (PBS)
- Recognizing and Reporting Abuse, Neglect, and Exploitation
- HCBS Settings Rule and Individual Rights

Within 120 Days of Hire

- Supporting Healthy Lives (NJ DSP Core Competency Module)
- Additional NJ DSP Core Competency Career Pathway modules as assigned

Annual Renewals

- CPR and First Aid (per certification cycle)
- Mandated Reporter
- Medication Administration (if applicable)
- Any additional training required by NJDDD or agency policy updates

> *Training Non-Compliance — Failure to complete required trainings within specified timeframes may result in removal from the schedule, suspension of services, and/or disciplinary action.*

7.7 Compensation & Benefits

- Pay Schedule: Bi-weekly
- Overtime: Pre-approved hours above 40/week paid at 1.5x per FLSA and NJ law
- Mileage Reimbursement: At current agency-approved rate, with documentation and supervisory approval
- Paid Sick Leave: Per NJ Earned Sick Leave Law (P.L. 2018, c. 10)
- Workers' Compensation: All workplace injuries must be reported immediately

7.8 Performance Evaluations

All new hires serve a 90-day probationary period. Performance reviews are conducted annually and as warranted. Progressive discipline progresses through Verbal Warning → Written Warning → Suspension → Termination. The agency reserves the right to skip steps for serious violations including abuse/neglect, HIPAA violations, fraud, violence, or conduct placing an individual at risk.

7.9 Workplace Safety & Violence Prevention

Zero-tolerance policy for workplace violence, harassment, intimidation, and bullying. Any threat must be reported immediately and, if necessary, law

enforcement contacted. DSPs may not bring weapons of any kind to any worksite.

7.10 Social Media & Technology Policy

- No Recording of Individuals — without explicit written agency authorization
- No Public Disclosure of individuals, co-workers, or agency operations
- Professional Electronic Communication only; no sensitive information through unsecured channels
- Agency Technology for work purposes only; no unauthorized software
- Violations may result in immediate termination and legal referral

SECTION 8

Compliance & Regulatory Framework

8.1 NJDDD Regulatory Oversight

NJDDD conducts periodic monitoring visits, record reviews, and compliance investigations. Cooperate fully, honestly, and professionally with any NJDDD review or investigation. Never conceal information from a regulatory reviewer.

8.2 NJ Administrative Code N.J.A.C. 10:44

N.J.A.C. 10:44 (Community Care Standards) governs community-based services for individuals with IDD. Key areas include provider eligibility, service delivery standards, individual rights, incident management, staff qualifications, and monitoring.

8.3 Federal HCBS Final Rule (42 CFR Part 441)

Establishes national standards for HCBS settings and individual rights. Non-compliance can result in loss of Medicaid funding and removal of individuals from non-compliant settings.

8.4 Medicaid Fraud, Waste, and Abuse

- Fraud: Intentional misrepresentation to obtain payment (e.g., billing for services not provided, falsifying documentation, inaccurate EVV)
- Waste: Overutilization of services resulting in unnecessary costs
- Abuse: Practices inconsistent with sound fiscal, business, or medical practice resulting in unnecessary cost to Medicaid

> *Zero Tolerance for Fraud — Medicaid fraud is a federal crime. Confirmed fraud will result in immediate termination, referral to the NJ Medicaid Fraud Control Unit, and potential criminal prosecution.*

8.5 Incident Management System (IMS)

NJDDD operates the IMS for required reportable event submissions. DSPs contribute by completing accurate written incident reports promptly and

cooperating with investigation.

8.6 Corrective Action Plans (CAPs)

CAPs are formal documents addressing identified compliance deficiencies. All staff are expected to cooperate with CAP implementation — they are designed to improve practice, not assign blame.

8.7 Whistleblower Protections

Under the NJ Conscientious Employee Protection Act (CEPA) and applicable federal law, employees who report in good faith are protected from retaliation.

SECTION 9

Emergency Procedures

> *Critical Safety Notice — In any emergency involving immediate risk to life, CALL 911 FIRST. Do not delay emergency response to contact your supervisor. Your first obligation is always the safety of the individual you support.*

9.1 Fire Evacuation Procedures

1. Activate the alarm (if not already) and call 911 immediately
2. Assist the individual in evacuating using the nearest safe exit — do not use elevators
3. Follow any individual-specific evacuation plan in the ISP
4. Close doors behind you as you exit — do not lock them
5. Proceed to the designated emergency meeting point and account for the individual
6. Do not re-enter the building until cleared by emergency responders
7. Notify your supervisor immediately by phone
8. Document the incident fully

> *DSP Tip — Know evacuation routes in every setting before an emergency occurs. On your first shift at a new location, identify all exits, fire extinguishers, and the meeting point.*

9.2 Medical Emergencies

1. Call 911 immediately
2. Remain with the individual — do not leave them alone
3. Follow dispatcher instructions; begin CPR/First Aid if trained and needed
4. Do not administer medications unless ISP-authorized and you have completed Medication Administration training
5. Notify your supervisor immediately after 911
6. Gather relevant information for emergency responders

7. Document the incident fully

9.3 Behavioral Crisis

1. Ensure your own safety first — create safe distance if at risk
2. Follow the individual's BSP/Crisis Plan exactly — do not improvise
3. Use approved de-escalation strategies — remain calm, low/steady tone, reduce demands, provide space, offer choices
4. Call your supervisor or agency crisis line if de-escalation is not effective
5. Call 911 if there is imminent risk of serious harm that cannot be managed safely
6. Never use physical restraint unless specifically trained and authorized — and only as last resort per protocol
7. Document the full incident immediately following resolution

9.4 Severe Weather & Natural Disasters

- Monitor weather alerts via NJ Emergency Management and local news
- Follow the agency's emergency preparedness plan for the event type
- Shelter in place if directed — interior room, away from windows, lowest floor for tornado/high winds
- Evacuate if directed by emergency management — follow agency routes
- Maintain communication with your supervisor throughout the event
- Ensure access to water, medications, and essential supplies
- Document actions and the individual's status

9.5 Missing Person Protocol

1. Do not wait — begin the protocol immediately
2. Search the immediate area quickly and safely (without abandoning other individuals)
3. Call 911 immediately — report as a missing vulnerable adult with description and last location
4. Notify your supervisor immediately by phone
5. Notify emergency contacts as directed by supervisor
6. Document all actions and the complete timeline

7. Cooperate fully with law enforcement, agency, and NJDDD investigation

> *Elopement Risk — If an individual has a documented history of elopement, review their ISP carefully for supervision requirements before beginning services. Never leave a high-risk individual unsupervised, even briefly.*

SECTION 10

Acknowledgment & Attestation

Staff Orientation Acknowledgment & Agreement

RELIANCE CARE SERVICES LLC — Provider Developed Orientation — NJ Division of Developmental Disabilities (NJDDD) Compliant.

By completing this orientation, I acknowledge and attest to the following:

1. I have received, read, and reviewed the Reliance Care Services LLC Staff Orientation Manual in its entirety, including all ten (10) sections.
2. I understand that this manual represents agency policies, procedures, and professional expectations to which I am held accountable.
3. I understand my obligations as a mandatory reporter under New Jersey law and my responsibilities related to HIPAA, confidentiality, and NJDDD regulatory compliance.
4. I will implement each individual's Individualized Support Plan (ISP) and Behavior Support Plan (BSP) with fidelity and professionalism.
5. I understand the Electronic Visit Verification (EVV) requirements applicable to my position and agree to comply in full.
6. I agree to uphold the mission, vision, core values, and professional standards of Reliance Care Services LLC.
7. I will direct questions about policies or procedures to my supervisor and will seek clarification rather than acting on assumptions.
8. I understand this manual satisfies the NJDDD Provider Developed Orientation training requirement, and I must complete additional required trainings within the timeframes in Section 7.6.

Confirming the acknowledgment below records that I have read and understood the contents of this manual and agree to be bound by its provisions.